THE IMMUTABLE ADVANTAGE

What it doesn't stop.

A read-only core changes what an attacker can make stick. It does not stop the first compromise.

INITIAL ACCESS

- A vulnerable web app
- An exposed SSH, database, or admin panel
- Weak or stolen credentials
- Phishing payloads
- An unpatched network daemon

AFTER ACCESS

- Code execution in memory
- Data theft from /home, /var, databases, and volumes
- Persistence in user config, cron, systemd user units, container volumes, or cloud credentials
- Kernel privilege escalation
- Re-exploiting the same hole after every reboot

BOTTOM LINE

Immutability raises the cost of a deep, lasting takeover and makes cleanup easier. It is not a shield against the first compromise.

STILL DO THE BASICS

- ✓ Expose only what you need
- ✓ Use keys and MFA
- ✓ Run with least privilege
- ✓ Patch everything
- ✓ Firewall aggressively